

Kioxia Holdings Corp

We met with the CFO

Demand is strong

During the Japan Big Tech tour, we had the opportunity to meet with CFO Yoshihiko Kawamura and Executive Officer Toshiaki Fujikawa. Their strong messages included: (1) NAND demand for AI data centres remains very strong, and the expansion of AI usage from learning to inference is accelerating demand for storage, particularly for enterprise SSDs; (2) Kioxia is deliberately targeting LTA coverage of around 50%, lower than that of competitors, and a shorter duration of three years, to take advantages of price upside and the flexibility to respond to technological change; (3) there is limited scope to alter the current five-year capex plan; and (4) M&A, if conducted, would likely raise concerns about profit margin decline.

The company is bullish on supply-demand

Management explained that NAND market supply-demand is unlikely to deteriorate in 2026 or 2027, while there are still too many uncertainties surrounding 2028. The key indicators it monitors closely to assess whether the favourable conditions will continue are hyperscalers' balance sheets, cash flows and inventories. Management also identified the context length of advanced AI models as an important indicator of NAND demand. We got the impression that the company believes supply-demand is unlikely to deteriorate based on its monitoring of these factors. Its strategy is to maximise profit through a framework that allows it to respond flexibly to market changes, rather than "locking in" pricing and supply volumes through LTAs. We also expect market changes to be on the positive side.

But no expansion of investment

The investment plans through 2032 total approximately ¥5trn for the two joint ventures, with Kioxia contributing around ¥3trn and SanDisk around ¥2trn. For Kitakami K3, the company aims to commence operations in FY3/30, front-loading the previous plan. For the time being, the company plans to utilise existing space at Yokkaichi Y7 and Kitakami K2, while proceeding with K3 on a "shell-first" basis by securing the building first. Although the company intends to determine the timing of equipment installation after assessing actual demand, this points to a proactive investment stance in anticipation of demand growth. However, management noted that it would be unrealistic to build new fabs K3, K4 and K5 in rapid succession, and that there is currently limited scope for major changes to the existing plan.

Valuation: Remaining bullish

Based on an average ROE of 48% for FY3/28-31, we estimate a COE of 9.1%. Applying a PBR of 5.23X, we derive a price target of ¥126,000.

Equities

Japan

Semiconductors

12-month rating

Buy

12m price target

¥126,000

Price (01 Oct 2026)

¥19,100

RIC: 285A.T BBG: 285A JP

Trading data and key metrics

52-wk range	¥108,700-5,410
Market cap.	¥10,467b/US\$66.1b
Shares o/s	548m (ORD)
Free float	30%
Avg. daily volume ('000)	40,276
Avg. daily value (m)	¥2,186,390.5
Common s/h equity (03/27E)	¥5610b
P/BV (03/27E)	1.7x
Net debt to EBITDA (03/27E)	NM

EPS (reported, basic) (JPY)

	UBS	Cons.
03/27E	12,685.5	3,476.0
03/28E	19,953.4	4,722.0
03/29E	16,428.7	5,361.5

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Highlights (¥b)	03/24	03/25	03/26	03/27E	03/28E	03/29E	03/30E	03/31E
Revenues	1,076.6	1,706.5	2,337.6	11,390.1	15,931.0	13,040.0	12,410.0	12,410.0
EBIT (UBS)	(252.7)	451.7	870.4	9,398.9	13,617.0	10,556.0	9,656.0	9,636.0
Net earnings (UBS)	(243.7)	272.3	554.5	6,478.6	9,422.2	7,304.5	6,682.2	6,668.8
EPS (UBS, diluted) (¥)	(452.1)	505.2	1,015.4	12,685.5	19,953.4	16,428.7	15,877.8	16,739.2
DPS (net) (¥)	0.0	0.0	0.0	1,268.5	3,990.7	3,285.7	3,175.6	3,347.8
Net (debt) / cash	(1,101.3)	(827.6)	(775.3)	2,087.2	6,889.4	11,814.3	15,917.8	19,878.2
Profitability/valuation	03/24	03/25	03/26	03/27E	03/28E	03/29E	03/30E	03/31E
EBIT (UBS) margin %	(23.5)	26.5	37.2	82.5	85.5	81.0	77.8	77.6
ROIC (EBIT) %	(15.3)	28.1	45.5	325.0	341.2	254.6	252.3	253.5
EV/EBITDA (UBS core) x	-	2.8	4.5	1.0	0.4	0.1	NM	NM
P/E (UBS, diluted) x	-	4.3	8.0	1.5	1.0	1.2	1.2	1.1
Equity FCF (UBS) yield %	-	15.4	7.1	48.7	81.6	74.6	64.4	63.0
Dividend yield (net) %	-	0.0	0.0	6.6	20.9	17.2	16.6	17.5

Source: Company accounts, LSEG Eikon, UBS estimates. Metrics marked as (UBS) have had analyst adjustments applied. Valuations: based on an average share price that year, (E): based on a share price of ¥ 19,100 on 01-Oct-2026 18:55:29 JST

Kioxia Holdings Corp (285A.T)

Income Statement (¥b)	03/24	03/25	03/26	03/27E	%ch	03/28E	%ch	03/29E	03/30E	03/31E
Revenues	1,076.6	1,706.5	2,337.6	11,390.1	387.3	15,931.0	39.9	13,040.0	12,410.0	12,410.0
Gross profit	(129.3)	569.4	1,012.9	9,688.9	NM	13,917.0	43.6	10,876.0	9,976.0	9,956.0
EBITDA (UBS)	93.4	764.1	1,183.2	9,748.9	NM	14,007.0	43.7	10,946.0	10,076.0	10,076.0
Depreciation & amortisation	(346.1)	(312.3)	(312.8)	(350.0)	-11.9	(390.0)	-11.4	(390.0)	(420.0)	(440.0)
EBIT (UBS)	(252.7)	451.7	870.4	9,398.9	NM	13,617.0	44.9	10,556.0	9,656.0	9,636.0
Associates & investment income	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	-	0.0	-	0.0	0.0	0.0
Other non-operating income	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	-	0.0	-	0.0	0.0	0.0
Net interest	(90.6)	(81.1)	(86.3)	(37.2)	56.9	(1.5)	95.9	(0.8)	(0.1)	0.6
Exceptionals (incl goodwill)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	-	0.0	-	0.0	0.0	0.0
Pre-tax profit	(343.3)	370.7	784.1	9,361.7	NM	13,615.5	45.4	10,555.2	9,655.9	9,636.6
Tax	99.6	(98.3)	(229.6)	(2,883.1)	NM	(4,193.3)	-45.4	(3,250.7)	(2,973.7)	(2,967.8)
Profit after tax	(243.7)	272.3	554.5	6,478.6	NM	9,422.2	45.4	7,304.5	6,682.2	6,668.8
Preference dividends	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	-	0.0	-	0.0	0.0	0.0
Minorities	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	-	0.0	-	0.0	0.0	0.0
Extraordinary items	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	-	0.0	-	0.0	0.0	0.0
Net earnings (local GAAP)	(243.7)	272.3	554.5	6,478.6	NM	9,422.2	45.4	7,304.5	6,682.2	6,668.8
Net earnings (UBS)	(243.7)	272.3	554.5	6,478.6	NM	9,422.2	45.4	7,304.5	6,682.2	6,668.8
Tax rate (%)	0.0	26.5	29.3	30.8	5.2	30.8	0.0	30.8	30.8	30.8
Per Share (¥)	03/24	03/25	03/26	03/27E	%ch	03/28E	%ch	03/29E	03/30E	03/31E
EPS (UBS, diluted)	(452.1)	505.2	1,015.4	12,685.5	NM	19,953.4	57.3	16,428.7	15,877.8	16,739.2
EPS (local GAAP, diluted)	(452.1)	505.2	1,015.4	12,685.5	NM	19,953.4	57.3	16,428.7	15,877.8	16,739.2
EPS (UBS, basic)	(452.1)	505.2	1,015.4	12,685.5	NM	19,953.4	57.3	16,428.7	15,877.8	16,739.2
DPS (net) (¥)	0.0	0.0	0.0	1,268.5	-	3,990.7	214.6	3,285.7	3,175.6	3,347.8
Cash EPS (UBS, diluted) ¹	189.8	1,084.5	1,588.2	13,370.8	NM	20,779.3	55.4	17,305.9	16,875.8	17,843.6
Book value per share	834.1	1,368.2	2,561.7	10,984.8	328.8	23,852.3	117.1	35,189.9	46,704.0	59,379.6
Average shares (diluted)	539.1	539.1	546.1	510.7	-6.5	472.2	-7.5	444.6	420.8	398.4
Balance Sheet (¥b)	03/24	03/25	03/26	03/27E	%ch	03/28E	%ch	03/29E	03/30E	03/31E
Cash and equivalents	192.9	171.9	477.9	2,278.6	376.8	7,066.1	210.1	11,975.9	16,063.7	20,008.1
Other current assets	458.4	634.8	1,139.9	2,543.3	123.1	3,430.5	34.9	2,961.3	2,924.1	2,929.6
Total current assets	651.4	806.7	1,617.8	4,821.9	198.0	10,496.6	117.7	14,937.2	18,987.8	22,937.6
Net tangible fixed assets	1,328.5	1,297.2	1,233.3	1,347.7	9.3	1,452.0	7.7	1,446.3	1,510.7	1,555.0
Net intangible fixed assets	406.7	405.9	406.8	406.8	0.0	406.8	0.0	406.8	406.8	406.8
Investments / other assets	478.4	409.8	432.1	432.1	0.0	432.1	0.0	432.1	432.1	432.1
Total assets	2,864.9	2,919.7	3,690.1	7,008.4	89.9	12,787.5	82.5	17,222.4	21,337.4	25,331.5
Trade payables & other ST liabilities	999.7	696.1	878.6	1,047.7	19.2	1,188.2	13.4	1,255.6	1,376.8	1,385.8
Short term debt	866.4	289.0	219.4	43.9	-80.0	43.9	0.0	43.9	43.9	43.9
Total current liabilities	1,866.1	985.2	1,098.0	1,091.6	-0.6	1,232.1	12.9	1,299.5	1,420.7	1,429.7
Long term debt	427.8	710.5	1,033.8	147.5	-85.7	132.8	-10.0	117.6	102.0	85.9
Other long term liabilities	121.3	486.3	159.2	159.2	0.0	159.2	0.0	159.2	159.2	159.2
Preferred shares	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	-	0.0	-	0.0	0.0	0.0
Total liabilities (incl pref shares)	2,415.2	2,182.0	2,291.0	1,398.3	-39.0	1,524.1	9.0	1,576.3	1,681.9	1,674.8
Common s/h equity	449.6	737.6	1,398.9	5,610.0	301.0	11,263.3	100.8	15,646.0	19,655.3	23,656.6
Minority interests	0.1	0.1	0.2	0.2	0.0	0.2	0.0	0.2	0.2	0.2
Total liabilities & equity	2,864.9	2,919.7	3,690.1	7,008.4	89.9	12,787.5	82.5	17,222.4	21,337.4	25,331.5
Cash Flow (¥b)	03/24	03/25	03/26	03/27E	%ch	03/28E	%ch	03/29E	03/30E	03/31E
Net income (before pref divs)	(243.7)	272.3	554.5	6,478.6	NM	9,422.2	45.4	7,304.5	6,682.2	6,668.8
Depreciation & amortisation	346.1	312.3	312.8	350.0	11.9	390.0	11.4	390.0	420.0	440.0
Net change in working capital	146.0	(183.8)	(400.3)	(1,234.3)	-208.3	(746.7)	39.5	536.6	158.5	3.5
Other operating	(56.6)	70.9	144.8	(5.3)	-	(4.9)	8.8	(4.4)	(3.9)	(3.5)
Operating cash flow	191.8	471.7	611.8	5,588.9	NM	9,060.6	62.1	8,226.6	7,256.7	7,108.9
Tangible capital expenditure	(324.2)	(291.6)	(295.4)	(494.3)	-67.3	(524.3)	-6.1	(414.3)	(514.3)	(514.3)
Intangible capital expenditure	(0.7)	(1.8)	(2.6)	0.0	-	0.0	-	0.0	0.0	0.0
Net (acquisitions) & disposals	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	-	0.0	-	0.0	0.0	0.0
Other investing	30.2	52.6	62.2	0.0	-	0.0	-	0.0	0.0	0.0
Investing cash flow	(294.6)	(240.8)	(235.8)	(494.3)	-109.6	(524.3)	-6.1	(414.3)	(514.3)	(514.3)
Equity dividends paid	0.0	0.0	0.0	(647.9)	-	(1,884.4)	-190.9	(1,460.9)	(1,336.4)	(1,333.8)
Share issues / (buybacks)	0.0	30.4	11.6	(1,619.6)	-	(1,884.4)	-16.3	(1,460.9)	(1,336.4)	(1,333.8)
Other financing	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	-	0.0	-	0.0	0.0	0.0
Change in debt & pref shares	26.3	(280.6)	(88.6)	(1,056.4)	NM	(9.8)	99.1	(10.8)	(11.7)	(12.6)
Financing cash flow	26.3	(250.2)	(77.0)	(3,323.9)	NM	(3,778.7)	-13.7	(2,932.6)	(2,684.6)	(2,680.2)
Cash flow inc/(dec) in cash	(76.5)	(19.3)	298.9	1,770.7	NM	4,757.6	168.7	4,879.8	4,057.8	3,914.4
FX / non cash items	6.3	(1.8)	7.0	30.0	325.7	30.0	0.0	30.0	30.0	30.0
Balance sheet inc/(dec) in cash	(70.2)	(21.0)	306.0	1,800.7	NM	4,787.6	165.9	4,909.8	4,087.8	3,944.4

Source: Company accounts, UBS estimates. (UBS) metrics use reported figures which have been adjusted by UBS analysts. ¹ Cash EPS (UBS, diluted) is calculated using UBS net income adding back depreciation and amortization.

Kioxia Holdings Corp (285A.T)

Valuation (x)	03/24	03/25	03/26	03/27E	03/28E	03/29E	03/30E	03/31E
P/E (local GAAP, diluted)	-	4.3	8.0	1.5	1.0	1.2	1.2	1.1
P/E (UBS, diluted)	-	4.3	8.0	1.5	1.0	1.2	1.2	1.1
P/CEPS	-	2.0	5.1	1.4	0.9	1.1	1.1	1.1
Equity FCF (UBS) yield %	-	15.4	7.1	48.7	81.6	74.6	64.4	63.0
Dividend yield (net) %	-	0.0	0.0	6.6	20.9	17.2	16.6	17.5
P/BV	-	1.6	3.2	1.7	0.8	0.5	0.4	0.3
EV/revenues (core)	-	1.3	2.3	0.9	0.4	0.1	NM	NM
EV/EBITDA (UBS core)	-	2.8	4.5	1.0	0.4	0.1	NM	NM
EV/EBIT (core)	-	4.8	6.1	1.0	0.4	0.1	NM	NM
EV/OpFCF (core)	-	2.8	4.5	1.0	0.4	0.1	NM	NM
EV/op. invested capital	-	1.4	2.8	3.4	1.5	0.3	NM	NM
Enterprise value (¥b)	03/24	03/25	03/26	03/27E	03/28E	03/29E	03/30E	03/31E
Market cap.	-	1,159.7	4,424.6	10,467.1	10,467.1	10,467.1	10,467.1	10,467.1
Net debt (cash)	1,051.6	964.4	801.5	(655.9)	(4,488.3)	(9,351.9)	(13,866.1)	(17,898.0)
Buy out of minorities	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.2
Pension provisions/other	49.1	47.5	44.7	42.9	42.9	42.9	42.9	42.9
Total enterprise value	-	2,171.8	5,270.9	9,854.2	6,021.8	1,158.2	(3,356.0)	(7,387.9)
Non core assets	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Core enterprise value	-	2,171.8	5,270.9	9,854.2	6,021.8	1,158.2	(3,356.0)	(7,387.9)
Growth (%)	03/24	03/25	03/26	03/27E	03/28E	03/29E	03/30E	03/31E
Revenue	(16.0)	58.5	37.0	NM	39.9	(18.1)	(4.8)	0.0
EBITDA (UBS)	(70.7)	NM	54.9	NM	43.7	(21.9)	(7.9)	0.0
EBIT (UBS)	(155.2)	-	92.7	NM	44.9	(22.5)	(8.5)	(0.2)
EPS (UBS, diluted)	(76.4)	-	101.0	NM	57.3	(17.7)	(3.4)	5.4
Net DPS	-	-	-	-	NM	(17.7)	(3.4)	5.4
Margins & Profitability (%)	03/24	03/25	03/26	03/27E	03/28E	03/29E	03/30E	03/31E
Gross profit margin	NM	33.4	43.3	NM	NM	NM	NM	NM
EBITDA margin	8.7	44.8	50.6	NM	NM	NM	NM	NM
EBIT (UBS) margin	(23.5)	26.5	37.2	82.5	85.5	81.0	77.8	77.6
Net earnings (UBS) margin	NM	16.0	23.7	56.9	59.1	56.0	53.8	53.7
ROIC (EBIT)	NM	28.1	45.5	NM	NM	NM	NM	NM
ROIC post tax	NM	20.7	32.1	NM	NM	NM	NM	NM
ROE (UBS)	(44.0)	45.9	51.9	184.9	111.7	54.3	37.9	30.8
Capital structure & Coverage (x)	03/24	03/25	03/26	03/27E	03/28E	03/29E	03/30E	03/31E
Net debt / EBITDA	11.8	1.1	0.7	(0.2)	(0.5)	(1.1)	(1.6)	(2.0)
Net debt / total equity %	244.9	112.2	55.4	(37.2)	(61.2)	(75.5)	(81.0)	(84.0)
Net debt / (net debt + total equity) %	71.0	52.9	35.7	(59.2)	NM	NM	NM	NM
Net debt/EV %	-	44.4	15.2	(6.7)	(74.5)	NM	NM	NM
Capex / depreciation %	93.7	93.4	94.4	141.2	134.4	106.2	122.5	116.9
Capex / revenue %	NM	17.1	12.6	4.3	3.3	3.2	4.1	4.1
EBIT / net interest	-	5.6	10.1	NM	NM	NM	NM	-
Dividend cover (UBS)	-	-	-	10.0	5.0	5.0	5.0	5.0
Div. payout ratio (UBS) %	-	-	-	10.0	20.0	20.0	20.0	20.0
Revenues by division (¥b)	03/24	03/25	03/26	03/27E	03/28E	03/29E	03/30E	03/31E
SSD & Storage	516.4	991.1	1,362.6	8,050.5	12,112.7	10,110.9	9,884.7	10,279.8
Smart Devices	374.3	501.1	760.0	3,010.5	3,398.3	2,469.1	1,975.3	1,580.2
Others	185.9	214.3	215.0	329.1	420.0	460.0	550.0	550.0
Total	1,076.6	1,706.5	2,337.6	11,390.1	15,931.0	13,040.0	12,410.0	12,410.0
EBIT (UBS) by division (¥b)	03/24	03/25	03/26	03/27E	03/28E	03/29E	03/30E	03/31E
Others	(252.7)	451.7	870.4	9,398.9	13,617.0	10,556.0	9,656.0	9,636.0
Total	(252.7)	451.7	870.4	9,398.9	13,617.0	10,556.0	9,656.0	9,636.0

Source: Company accounts, UBS estimates. (UBS) metrics use reported figures which have been adjusted by UBS analysts.

Forecast returns

Forecast price appreciation	559.7%
Forecast dividend yield	13.8%
Forecast stock return	573.5%
Market return assumption	8.1%
Forecast excess return	565.4%

Company Description

Kioxia is a leading global semiconductor manufacturer specializing in NAND flash memory and SSDs, holding a top-tier market share in this field. Originating from Toshiba's memory business, it operates as a dedicated manufacturer focused on the NAND business, offering products tailored for data centers and smart devices.

Valuation Method and Risk Statement

Our price target is based on PBR. Risk factors include: 1) strong cyclicalities of the NAND market and potential price declines following supply-demand equilibrium, 2) reduced demand due to a slowdown in AI investment and restrained semiconductor investment, 3) uncertainty regarding the sustainability of technological superiority, and 4) high profit leverage during periods of price increases.

Quantitative Research Review

UBS Global Research publishes a quantitative assessment of its analysts' responses to certain questions about the likelihood of an occurrence of a number of short term factors in a product known as the 'Quantitative Research Review'. The views for this month can be found below. Views contained in this assessment on a particular stock reflect only the views on those short term factors which are a different timeframe to the 12-month timeframe reflected in any equity rating set out in this note. For previous responses please make reference to (i) previous UBS Global Research reports; and (ii) where no applicable research report was published that month, the Quantitative Research Review which can be found at <https://neo.ubs.com/quantitative>, or contact your UBS sales representative for access to the report or the Quantitative Research Team on ubs-quant-answers@ubs.com. A consolidated report which contains all responses is also available and again you should contact your UBS sales representative for details and pricing or the Quantitative Research Team on the email above.

Kioxia Holdings Corp

Question	Response
1. Is the industry structure facing the firm likely to improve or deteriorate over the next six months? Rate on a scale of 1-5 (1 = getting worse, 3 = no change, 5 = getting better, N/A = no view)	5
2. Is the regulatory/government environment facing the firm likely to improve or deteriorate over the next six months? Rate on a scale of 1-5 (1 = getting tougher, 3 = no change, 5 = getting better, N/A = no view)	4
3. Over the last 3-6 months in broad terms have things been improving/no change/getting worse for this stock? Rate on a scale of 1-5 (1 = getting a lot worse, 3 = not much change, 5 = getting a lot better, N/A = no view)	5
4. Relative to the current CONSENSUS EPS forecast, is the next company EPS update likely to lead to: (1 = negative surprise vs consensus, 3 = in-line with consensus, 5 = positive surprise vs consensus expectations, N/A = no view)	3
5. What's driving the difference?	
6. Relative to YOUR current earnings forecast, is there relatively greater risk at the next earnings result of: (1 = downside skew risk to earnings, 3 = equal upside or downside risk to earnings, 5 = upside skew risk to earnings, N/A = no view)	4
7. What's driving the difference?	Continued rises in bit prices
8. Is there an upcoming catalyst for the company over the next three months?	No Catalyst
9. Is there an actual or approximate date for the catalyst?	
10. Is the catalyst date an actual or approximate date?	
11. What is the catalyst?	

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12-Month Rating	Definition	Coverage ¹	IB Services ²
Buy	FSR is > 6% above the MRA.	55%	24%
Neutral	FSR is between -6% and 6% of the MRA.	40%	21%
Sell	FSR is > 6% below the MRA.	6%	21%

Source: UBS. Rating allocations are as of 30 June 2026.

1:Percentage of companies under coverage globally within the 12-month rating category.

2:Percentage of companies within the 12-month rating category for which investment banking (IB) services were provided within the past 12 months.

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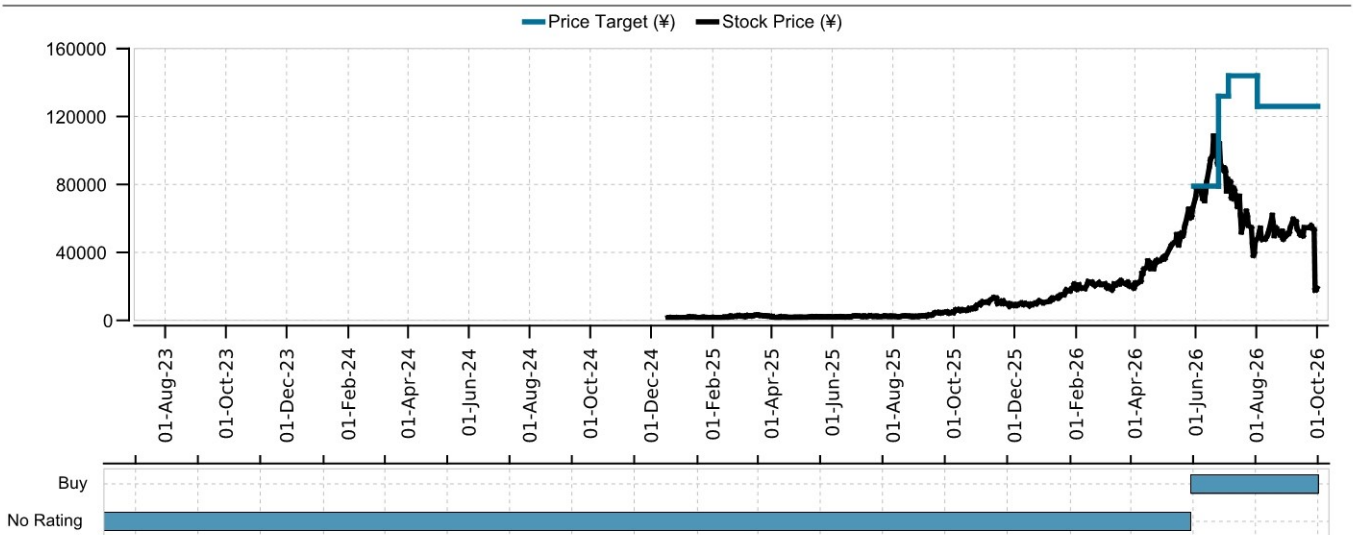
Company Name	Reuters	12-month rating	Price	Price date
Kioxia Holdings Corp ²⁸	285A.T	Buy	¥19,100	01 Oct 2026

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon. All prices as of local market close. Ratings in this table are the most current published ratings prior to this report. They may be more recent than the stock pricing date.

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Kioxia Holdings Corp (¥)



Date	Stock Price (¥)	Price Target (¥)	Rating
2023-06-30	NaN	-	No Rating
2026-05-29	65850	79000	Buy
2026-06-23	92290	132000	Buy
2026-07-03	83300	144000	Buy
2026-08-01	46500	126000	Buy

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 01-Oct-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

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